

Medalists of Gujarat State in India Skill Competition-2025-26



Industry-Academia. NSDC and Sector Skill Council Outreach Program for Namo Gujarat Kaushalya and Rojgar Mission

GUJARAT'S HEAD START

Gujarat has moved faster than most states in putting this model to work. Requests for proposals for Anchor Industry Partners are already out across two phases of ITI clusters — Surat, Rajkot, Gandhidham and Vadodara in the first phase, and Dholera, Morbi-Surendranagar and Halol-Panchmahal in the second — mapped against the state's industrial corridors from North Gujarat down to Kutch and Saurashtra. A State Project Management Unit is in place, a Project Management Consultant has been engaged, and industry consultations through the first half of 2026 have drawn in companies including Reliance Industries, Tata Electronics, Polycab India, Yokohama, Borosil and Maruti Suzuki.

The clearest proof point came on 20th June 2026, when Gujarat's Second State Steering Committee for PM-SETU approved a Strategic Investment Plan submitted by ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India (AM/NS India) for the Surat cluster, with NAMTECH as academic partner. The proposal scored 88 out of 100 on technical evaluation and commits close to ₹240 crore over five years — roughly ₹145 crore for infrastructure and equipment, ₹29 crore for trainer development, and nearly ₹50 crore ring-fenced specifically for employment outcomes such as placements and apprenticeships. Polycab India has since expressed interest in the Panchmahal cluster, and Maruti Suzuki in the Surendranagar cluster, signalling that Gujarat's manufacturing majors increasingly treat ITI upgradation as core business rather than corporate social responsibility.



> "Our key objective is to provide global-level technical training to the youth and ensure every young person becomes self-reliant under the Skill India mission."
>
> – Shri Kunvarjibhai Bavaliya
> Cabinet Minister, Labour, Skill Development & Employment, Government of Gujarat

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR INDUSTRY

For a company scaling operations in Gujarat, these two missions offer a rare combination: a single-window skilling framework through NGKRM, and a direct route to co-designing your own talent pipeline through PM-SETU, with government sharing the capital cost and the compliance burden. On the NGKRM side, a tiered network of training partners — from large industry consortia running production-grade training on their own shop floors, down to general training partners covering all 34 districts — is being built out toward a combined capacity of five lakh trainees a year. Sectors from automotive and electronics to green energy and logistics are already inside this system, and the framework allows new priority sectors to be added as industry demand shifts, including emerging areas like semiconductors, drones, AI and electric vehicles.

The state has also been deliberate about widening the talent pool feeding into this system, including dedicated pathways for women entering technical trades, first-generation industrial workers, and youth in rural and tribal districts — a broader base of skilled manpower that ultimately benefits the industries drawing from it.

THE BIGGER PICTURE

Viksit Gujarat @2047 rests on a target most industrial planners recognise well: moving a much larger share of the state's population into productive, formal employment over the next two decades. NGKRM and PM-SETU are the two instruments Gujarat is using to get there — one building the governance and financing architecture for skilling at scale, the other putting industry directly in charge of the institutes producing that talent.

For industry leaders, the message is straightforward: Gujarat is not just offering land, power and logistics for the next phase of India's industrial growth. It is offering to build the workforce alongside you.



> "Skilled youth are the true strength of our nation and can contribute significantly to India's economic growth, national progress and nation building."
>
> – Shri Kantilal Amrutiya
> Minister of State, Labour, Skill Development & Employment, Government of Gujarat



> "By bridging the gap between education and dynamic industry demands, Gujarat continues to set a benchmark in empowering workers and fostering a skilled, global workforce."
>
> Shri Lochan Sehra, IAS
> Secretary, Labour, Skill Development & Employment Department, Government of Gujarat